

The Claude Code Mindset

10 PRINCIPLES THAT MATTER MORE THAN COMMANDS

1 One Task Per Session

Start each task with `/clear`. A focused context produces focused output. Context bloat is the #1 cause of bad AI code.

2 Spec Quality = Output Quality

A vague prompt gets vague code. Write requirements like you're briefing a senior developer: what it should do, what it shouldn't, what constraints matter.

3 You're the Architect

Describe WHAT you want, not HOW to build it. Your job is intent, judgment, and review. Claude's job is implementation.

4 Never Trust, Always Verify

Claude is confident even when wrong. Run the tests. Read the diff. Check the output. "Make it better" is always a valid prompt.

5 Teach Before You Configure

Write CLAUDE.md as behavioral policy, not docs. "Always use parameterized queries" changes output. "We use PostgreSQL" doesn't.

6 Precision Over Volume

Fix the null check in `@src/auth.js` line 42 beats fix the auth bug every time. Specific prompts mean fewer iterations.

7 Plan When It Matters

Multi-file changes? Plan Mode (Shift+Tab). Single-line fix? Just ask. If you can describe the diff in one sentence, skip the plan.

8 Match the Model to the Task

Haiku for bulk renames. Sonnet for features. Opus for complex debugging. Don't pay for a brain surgeon to apply a bandage.

9 Iterate, Don't Regenerate

80% right is the starting point. Tell Claude what's wrong and let it fix it. Three rounds of refinement beats one attempt at perfection.

10 Session Hygiene is a Skill

`/clear` between tasks. `/compact` when context grows. `/context` to check your budget. Master these three and outperform everyone.

ESSENTIAL COMMANDS

`/clear` · `/compact` · `/context` · `/model` · Shift+Tab · `@filename`

The tool changes every month. These principles don't.

© 2026 AIA Copilot — Claude Code Training · aiacopilot.com